like running, he asked me if I knew how many secretaries, joint secretaries and additional secretaries at the central level were from Dalit, tribal and backward communities. I told him that I did not have any official data on this. Then he showed me data on his mobile phone, which revealed that there was not a single additional secretary in the Central government ministries who was from the backward classes,[2] whereas, among the secretaries, only one was a Dalit and three tribals. Only 4 per cent Dalits, 3 per cent tribals and 7 per cent OBCs occupied the post of joint secretary.[3]

The Modi government enjoys votes from the OBC community, but does not give them power and does not work for them. That is why we are talking about caste census, so that if there is sufficient caste data, each person will be able to get their rights as per their population. But the Modi government is not doing this. We do not want this inequality. We want to ensure social justice for people. This will happen only when there is data and facts obtained from the caste census.

Rahul ji said that the Congress had always stood in favour of backward, tribal and Dalit communities and would continue to do so. He said he wanted the forces of social justice to come forward. The steering of the Congress bus should be in their hands. He said he wanted to make these sections powerful, that he wanted the Congress to give them strength. He added that Dalit and backward caste members should come forward and take charge of the Congress.

During his visit to Rajasthan, Rahul Gandhi interacted with women and youth from the minority community. He walked with human rights activists. He held meetings with Dalit organizations. He had walking discussions with activists working on tribal rights. He met activists fighting against the environmental and ecological damage caused by illegal mining in the Aravalli hills. He walked with girls from Dalit, tribal and minority communities. He also met nomads (denotified tribes/communities), farmers, labourers, poets, writers and members of the alternative media—basically from every section of society. Whoever came to meet him was of the opinion that he was a nice, sensitive man, who listened to everyone but also